

FOUNDRY

Internal Strategy Blueprint

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Foundry is the operational backbone of Allmer Group. It manufactures products to exacting standards, builds and maintains a global network of certified artisans and domain experts, and runs experimental research that no competitor can replicate. It serves Allmer brands and selected external partners. It does not advertise. It is known in the right rooms.

1. Structure

Foundry operates as a wholly owned subsidiary of Allmer Group, sitting alongside Simon Allmer Entertainment in the holding structure. It is not a creative entity. It is the industrial and intellectual infrastructure that makes creative output physically possible and globally consistent.

Foundry Works

Precision fabrication facility powered by AI-driven production workflows. Executes manufacturing to defined standards for all Allmer product lines and selected partner brands. The AI agent does not distinguish between an intricate steel board game and high-specification packaging. It receives a standard and fulfills it.

Partner capacity model: Allmer production occupies scheduled machine time. Idle capacity — Monday night, off-peak windows — is sold to external partners at accessible minimum order quantities. A Parisian confectionary that cannot afford bespoke glassware through conventional supply chains can commission a Foundry Works run that reflects its brand DNA. Same machines. Same quality. Different client.

Foundry Labs

The experimental division. A small team of domain experts — molecular gastronomists, materials scientists, stage technicians, specialist craftspeople — whose accumulated knowledge is the asset. Labs does not produce to brief. It investigates, prototypes, and encodes discoveries into Foundry's production standards, feeding Works with capabilities that did not exist before.

Labs knowledge is tacit by design. The output is not a report. It is a process embedded in people and machines that cannot be reverse-engineered from the finished product.

2. The Dual Strategy

Foundry operates two systems simultaneously. Neither is subordinate to the other. Together they produce something no single-mode competitor can replicate.

Automated Precision

- AI-agent-driven fabrication workflows executing to defined tolerance and quality standards
- Consistent output regardless of product type or client — board game components and snack packaging run on the same logic
- Cost structure achievable only through eliminated intermediaries and Allmer-owned real estate
- Idle capacity converted to partner revenue without cannibalizing Allmer production schedules

Irreplaceable Human Networks

- Certified artisan and expert network across eleven city hubs
- Long-term relationships with domain specialists whose knowledge cannot be hired away, only cultivated
- Cross-discipline learning at hub level: the woodworker who learns stone becomes a product category that did not previously exist
- Foundry acts as connector, standardiser, and quality guarantor — the artisan retains individual character within defined parameters

The Connector Model

The Salon Edition of Seven Wonders illustrates the full model. A Parisian artisan receives precisely milled components from a nearby Foundry Works supplier — standard dimensions, defined tolerances, delivered through an automated pipeline. The artisan handcrafts the finished piece. The result is sold to Parisian cafés and private collectors. The same piece sold in Tokyo carries the same form. The artisan's individual character is retained within that form. Foundry sets the standard. The network provides the soul.

3. The Maintenance Model

Foundry offers institutional clients — hotel chains, high-end retailers, cultural institutions — a low-cost maintenance subscription covering inspection, repair, and replacement of Foundry-produced pieces. Priced at a level only Foundry can sustain profitably, due to owned real estate, eliminated logistics overhead, and the existing certified network already present in each city.

Most manufacturers do not offer this service. The gap is structural: they lack the physical proximity and the human network to make it economical. Foundry's architecture makes it natural.

The subscription converts a one-time sale into a long-term institutional relationship. Switching cost is high: the client would need to rebuild the operational relationship with a provider who does not have Foundry's network or cost structure. The subscription is priced to make switching irrational.

4. The Guild Model

Foundry is, in structural terms, a modern guild. The historical guild concentrated craft knowledge within a city, enforced quality standards, controlled access, trained members across adjacent disciplines, and marked output with a signal that circulated only in the right circles. Foundry replicates this model with contemporary infrastructure.

City Hubs

Foundry operates physical hubs in each city of Allmer Group operations. These are not satellite offices. They are the places where the certified network gathers, trains, experiments, and collaborates. The hub is where cross-discipline learning compounds — the thing that creates network effects.

City	Country	Region	Craft Density
Vienna	Austria	Europe	Metalwork, furniture, confectionery, clockmaking
London	UK	Europe	Tailoring, ceramics, typography, fine joinery
Paris	France	Europe	Woodcraft, gastronomy, glasswork, textile
Rome	Italy	Europe	Leather, marble, mosaic, culinary
New York City	USA	North America	Industrial design, print, culinary innovation

City	Country	Region	Craft Density
Los Angeles	USA	North America	Materials, fabrication, screen craft
Chicago	USA	North America	Architecture craft, steel, culinary
Singapore	Singapore	Asia-Pacific	Precision engineering, gastronomy, textile
Hong Kong	Hong Kong	Asia-Pacific	Jade, ceramics, tailoring, lacquer
Seoul	South Korea	Asia-Pacific	Ceramic, metal, paper craft, culinary
Tokyo	Japan	Asia-Pacific	Wood joinery, ceramics, lacquer, blade craft

Network Effects

The more certified members in a hub, the more cross-discipline exchange occurs. A woodworker who gains access to a stone specialist creates multi-material products that neither could produce alone. The network becomes more valuable to each member as the network grows. This is not a social effect. It is a knowledge compounding effect with direct product consequences.

Knowledge does not stay in individual heads. Foundry Labs encodes tacit expertise into standards, techniques, and training protocols that propagate across the network. What the Tokyo hub learns about lacquer finishes is available — in standardised form — to the Vienna hub working on a new product line.

Certification and Access

Membership in the Foundry network is earned, not purchased. Certified members receive sustained work, access to the broader network and its collaborative projects, knowledge preservation infrastructure, and participation in long-term Allmer productions. The benefits compound with tenure. The cost of leaving rises proportionally.

5. The Brand Signal

Foundry does not advertise. There are no campaigns, no television spots, no press releases directed at consumer audiences. The signal travels through the work and through the people who encounter it.

In the right room — a hotel acquisition meeting, a private collector's study, a Michelin-starred kitchen — “is this made by Foundry” is the entire campaign. This is the Hermès model applied to manufacturing infrastructure: quiet, specific, and inaccessible by definition to those who have not earned proximity to it.

The 40/60 container split on Allmer Group shipments — Allmer-branded alongside partner-branded cargo — is not a brand statement. It is operational reality. Foundry's identity does not require a logo on every container. It requires that the contents be undeniably correct.

6. Competitive Architecture: Seven Powers

Analysis against Hamilton Helmer's Seven Powers framework. Powers are assessed as Operative (active and defensible now), Emerging (architecture in place, not yet at scale), or Not Present.

Power	Status	Foundry Application
Counter-Positioning	Operative	No competitor runs AI-driven precision fabrication alongside a certified artisan guild. A large manufacturer cannot build the network without abandoning scale logic. An artisan collective cannot build the automation without losing its identity. Replication requires becoming something fundamentally different.
Switching Costs	Operative	Certified artisans accumulate benefits — sustained work, network access, knowledge infrastructure — that compound with tenure. Institutional maintenance subscribers face high operational switching costs: rebuilding the relationship with a provider lacking Foundry's network and cost structure is irrational at any reasonable subscription price.
Process Power	Operative	Foundry Labs encodes tacit knowledge into production standards. The output can be examined. The process cannot be reverse-engineered from it. Years of molecular gastronomy experiments, material research, and cross-discipline artisan training produce embedded workflows that are structurally unavailable to competitors who did not build them.
Cornered Resource	Emerging	The best craftspeople in each hub city are finite. Active cultivation of long-term exclusive and semi-exclusive relationships, before the model achieves public recognition, corners access to the top tier of each craft discipline. Requires intentional investment now. The window closes as the model is proven.
Network Effects	Emerging	Hub concentration drives cross-discipline knowledge compounding. Value to each certified member increases as the network grows — more disciplines, more collaborative project types, more complex output categories. Operative at hub scale. Requires reaching critical mass per city.
Scale Economies	Emerging	Maintenance subscription fixed costs spread across growing subscriber base. Owned real estate and eliminated intermediaries create a cost floor competitors cannot match.

Power	Status	Foundry Application
		Not yet operative at current subscriber volume. Architecture is correct.
Branding	Early Signal	No campaigns. Signal travels through the work and through proximity. “Is this made by Foundry” in the right room is the model. Hermès did not begin with the orange box as a global symbol.

7. What Foundry Is Not

- Foundry is not a logistics company. Global shipping at scale requires Hamilton Scale Economies that Foundry cannot access. Distribution is handled at the partner or Allmer brand level.
 - Foundry is not a creative studio. It executes to standards set by Simon Allmer Entertainment and by partner briefs. It does not originate product concepts or brand direction.
 - Foundry is not a consultancy. Its knowledge is embedded in production, not sold as advice.
 - Foundry does not advertise to consumers. Its audience is institutional and professional. Word of mouth within those circles is the only channel.
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